

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

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## Minnie Malist

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*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

## INTRODUCTIONS



### Minnie Malist

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#### *Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer*

Minnie considers restrained lighting a cry for help. Minnie creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp.

- Works constantly with **Frank Lloyd Wrong**, who removes half of Minnie's ideas.
- **Brie DeVivre** is Minnie's favorite partner in event logistics.
- **Monet Bags** is the person who asks what Minnie's ideas cost.

#### ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

#### YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Minnie Malist. I produce the events. A successful gala is one in which nobody notices how close it came to collapsing.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*



Minnie Malist

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## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to add a gaudy lighting cue to the unveiling and threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected.

### Your other secret

You secretly changed the cue again after approval, causing the eerie light flickers guests noticed during Act I.

### Conversations to start

- Ask Frank Lloyd Wrong which lighting cue he objected to.
- Ask Monet Bags whether the gala budget includes Grant's last-minute changes.

*If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.*

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *The clue is inside the book whose final chapter is Revelation.*
- 2 *The hard metal seat has an understudy: a clue waiting underneath.*
- 3 *A picture may be worth a thousand words. There are more words behind this one.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



## Minnie Malist

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

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#### **Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

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#### **Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

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#### **Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

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#### **Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

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#### **Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

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#### **Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

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#### **Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

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#### **Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

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#### **Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

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#### **Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

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*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

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Minnie Malist

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

Grant demanded a ghastly lighting cue, Frank objected, and my payment became the hostage. I changed the cue after approval. The flicker was mine. He wanted me to apologize for disobeying him while accepting responsibility for whatever his version would have done. I had invoices from people who could not pay their rent with donor gratitude.

#### IF MURDERER

I changed the lighting cue after approval because Grant's version was awful. He threatened to withhold payment when Frank objected. The flicker you saw was my late edit. Grant intended to blame the designer and stop the cheque. I was very tired of producing an evening for a man who thought payment was another creative note.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



**Minnie Malist**

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

Where were you before the toast, and why?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

Where did your work take you before the toast?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

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*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

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## ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Minnie Malist

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### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I stayed at the show-control desk running the manual tests before the toast. The pink worklight was on because I had forgotten the overhead cue again. I returned to the gallery after the test finished. Grant's latest demand was beside the unpaid invoice, where I could keep both sources of irritation in view.

#### IF MURDERER

I put the console into its saved test sequence and watched the gallery lights before the toast. The pink worklight stayed on at the desk. I had discussed Grant's demands at his salon earlier and carried his marked cue sheet with me. He had added another change in the margin after approving the previous one.

*You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



**Minnie Malist**

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### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

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**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What materials or records passed through your hands?

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**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

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**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

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**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

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**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

Which objects or records need your explanation?

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**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

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**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

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**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

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**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

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*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

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Minnie Malist

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# Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

## IF INNOCENT

The pink-worklight recording and manual-contact log run 6:49 to 6:55 on the brass overlay. My hands stay on the test faders. I had used the setup key for linen screens earlier. I changed the cue without approval, but my console cannot operate the security curtain. Please let each machine retain responsibility for its own disaster.

## IF MURDERER

The saved test sequence can run without my hands on the faders. I took a linen screen with the setup key and kept Grant's marked cue sheet. My console is separate from the curtain controller. The unauthorized lighting edit remains mine. I wanted the room to look good even if the person paying for it refused to behave.

*The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



**Minnie Malist**

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## Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

**Your character name**

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**I accuse**

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**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

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**Best Actor**

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**Best Costume**

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**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Minnie Malist

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## The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I changed the cue and caused the flicker. The manual-contact log and desk camera, with their overlay corrected, keep me at the console during the contamination interval. They also distinguish my lights from the security curtain. I wanted payment and a competent show. I did not poison the donor to obtain either.

### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The console ran its saved test while I left the desk. The linen screen carried the stolen reference sample; I wiped Grant's coupe during the private-service interval. His marked cue sheet let me look like an exhausted producer making one more correction. I killed the man withholding payment. The lighting change was only the smaller secret.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*